Ma Quetilye Quenya?

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Introduction

Welcome to this journey of learning Quenya!

My intention with this book is to make learning Quenya a playful, gradual, and highly practical experience. Imagine you are in a classroom, learning a living language step by step, focusing on communication and real-world-like scenarios rather than dry linguistic theory.

You don't need any prior theoretical background in linguistics, nor do you need to possess a deep, encyclopedic knowledge of J.R.R. Tolkien's Legendarium. If you love the sound of this Elven tongue and want to learn how to speak it, you are in the right place!

The structure of this book is inspired by the excellent language learning series *Schwätzt Dir Lëtzebuergesch?*. We will focus on dialogues, everyday situations, and building your vocabulary and grammar organically as we progress. The goal is to get you speaking and understanding Quenya in a natural, intuitive way.

Elen síla lúmenn' omentielvo! (A star shines on the hour of our meeting!)

How to read this book

- **The chapters are in Quenya only.** Pictures, dialogues and recordings carry the meaning. When you need a translation, every word of a chapter is listed at its end under *Quettar* (words) and *Essi* (names), and each one links to its entry in Eldamo, the lexicon this book follows.
- **Á lasta!** ("listen!") followed by a number, such as 1.2, marks a recording: the first number is the chapter, the second the track. On the website the recording plays in place; in the PDF and EPUB the number tells you which file to play from the book's audio folder.
- **The Eldamo column** says how a word is attested, in Eldamo's own notation: **Q.** a word from Tolkien's later Quenya; **MQ.** from his "Middle Quenya" writings of the 1930s and 1940s; **EQ.** from his early "Qenya" of the 1910s and 1920s; **NQ.** a Neo-Quenya neologism recorded by Eldamo; `*` a reconstructed or extrapolated form; `#` a word attested only inside a longer word or name. Nothing is invented silently: our own coinages are collected in the Neologisms chapter.

- **Grammar is shown, not explained.** Pattern tables set the pieces side by side, with the ending in bold after the stem. Say the rows aloud with the recording and the pattern will settle.
- **Tengwar**, the Elvish letters of *The Lord of the Rings*, get a short section in each chapter, a few letters at a time. Quenya writes its vowels as marks (*tehtar*) above the consonant they follow. A vowel with no consonant before it sits on a short stem, and a long vowel on a long stem. On the website, pointing at a Tengwar word shows its Latin spelling, except in the reading exercises.
- **Exercises** come at the end of each chapter under *Carië* ("doing"); the answers are under *Hanquentar* ("answers"), folded away on the website so you can try first.

Contributing

Contributions to this project are more than welcome! Whether you are interested in writing new chapters, reviewing content, creating illustrations, or providing translations, your help is deeply appreciated. Please check out our CONTRIBUTING.md guide for more details on how to get involved.

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Chapter	Topics	Pronunciation and grammar
Chapter 1	Greeting and saying goodbye, informally and formally; the times of day; asking and giving a name; saying where you come from and which people you belong to; saying which language you speak; counting to ten	Vowels, diphthongs and the spellings *c*, *qu*, *y*; *ná-* (to be); the endings *-n* (I) and *-lyë* (you); *-nya* (my) and *-lya* (your); *-llo* (from); questions with *ma*, answered with *ná* or *úi*; Tengwar: the vowel marks (*tehtar*) on the short and long stems, *númen*, *malta*, *lambë*, *rómen* and *órë*
Chapter 2	Content	pronunciation and grammar
Chapter 3	Content	pronunciation and grammar
Chapter 4	Content	pronunciation and grammar
Chapter 5	Content	pronunciation and grammar
Chapter 6	Content	pronunciation and grammar

1 Parandë

1.1 Aiya!... ar Namárië!



Figure 1.1: Aiya!

Á lasta! 1.1

- **Alla! … Á na márië!**
- **Aiya! … Namárië!**

Elenwë ar Nerdanel

Á lasta! 1.2

Elenwë: Alla, Nerdanel!
Nerdanel: Alla, Elenwë! Manen nalyë?
Elenwë: Mára, hantanyel. Ar elyë?
Nerdanel: Mára.
Elenwë: Á na márië, Nerdanel!
Nerdanel: Á na márië!

Elendil ar Rúmil

Á lasta! 1.3

Elendil: Aiya, Rúmil! Elen síla lúmenn' omentielvo.
Rúmil: Aiya, Elendil! Elen síla lúmenn' omentielvo. Manen nalyë?
Elendil: Mára, hantanyel. Ar elyë?
Rúmil: Mára. Namárië, Elendil!
Elendil: Namárië!

Manen nalyë?	Mára, hantanyel. Ar elyë?
Manen nalyë?	Mára.

1.2 Lúmë

Á lasta! 1.4

lúmë	Mára …!
amaurë	**Mára amaurë!**
aurë	**Mára aurë!**
endaurë	**Mára endaurë!**
apárilë	**Mára apárilë!**
undómë	
sinyë	**Mára sinyë!**
lómë	**Mára lómë!**

Á lasta! 1.5



Figure 1.2: Lúmë

Voronwë: Mára amaurë, Nerdanel!
Nerdanel: Mára amaurë, Voronwë!

Rúmil: Mára sinyë, Elenwë!
Elenwë: Mára sinyë, Rúmil! Manen nalyë?
Rúmil: Mára, hantanyel.

Elendil: Mára lómë, Voronwë!
Voronwë: Mára lómë, Elendil! Namárië!

1.3 Mana esselya?

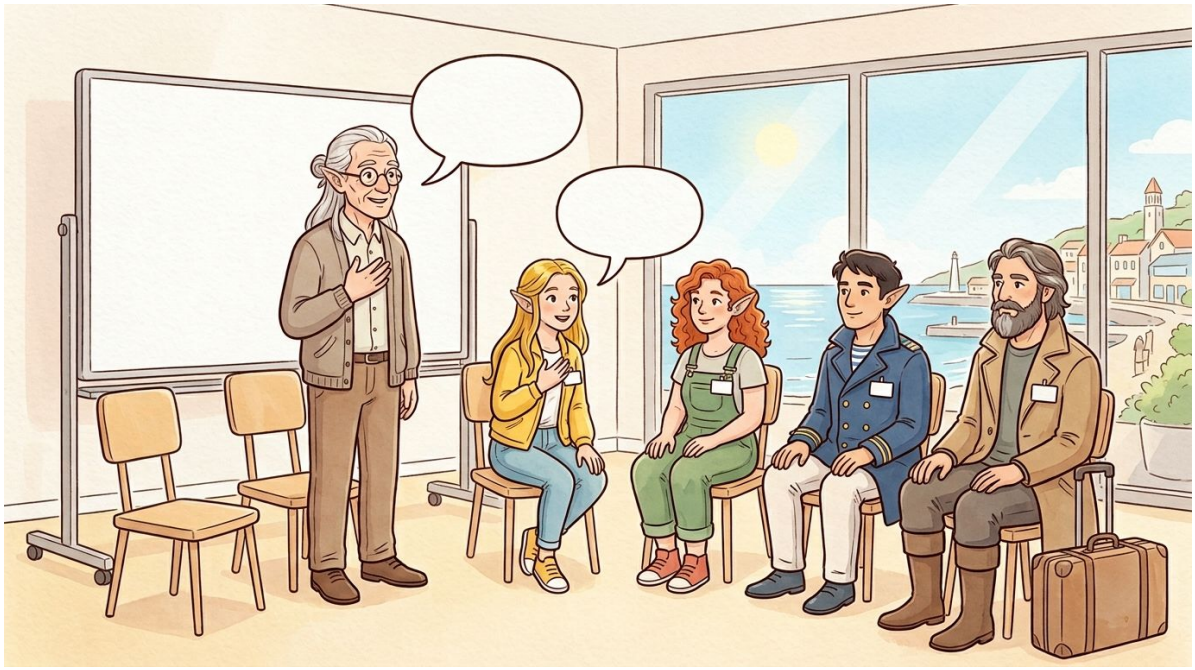


Figure 1.3: Mana esselya?

Mi Avallónë

Á lasta! 1.6

Rúmil: Aiya! Essenya ná Rúmil. Nanyë istyar. Mana esselya?
Elenwë: Aiya, Rúmil! Essenya ná Elenwë.
Rúmil: Ar elyë? Mana esselya?
Voronwë: Essenya ná Voronwë.

Rúmil: Ar elyë?
Nerdanel: Essenya ná Nerdanel.
Rúmil: Ar elyë?
Elendil: Essenya ná Elendil.
Rúmil: Alla, Elenwë! Alla, Voronwë! Alla, Nerdanel! Alla, Elendil!

essë	
ni	essë**nya**
elyë	essë**lya**

	ná-
ni	**nanyë**
elyë	**nalyë**
se	**ná**

Mana esselya?	Essenya ná Elenwë.
Mana esselya?	Essenya ná Rúmil. Nanyë istyar.

1.4 Mallo tulilyë?

Á lasta! 1.7

Rúmil: Elenwë, mallo tulilyë?
Elenwë: Tulin Valimarello. Nanyë Vanya.
Rúmil: Ar elyë, Nerdanel? Mallo tulilyë?
Nerdanel: Tulin Tirionello. Nanyë Noldo.
Rúmil: Voronwë, mallo tulilyë?
Voronwë: Tulin Endórello. Nanyë Noldo.
Rúmil: Ma quetilyë Quenya?
Voronwë: Ná, quetin Quenya ar Sindarin.
Rúmil: Ar elyë, Elendil? Mallo tulilyë?
Elendil: Tulin Númenórello. Nanyë Atan.
Rúmil: Ma quetilyë Sindarin?
Elendil: Ui, lá quetin Sindarin. Quetin Quenya.

	-llo
Valimar	Valimar**ello**

	-llo
Tirion	Tirion**ello**
Alqualondë	Alqualond**ello**
Avallónë	Avallón**ello**
Endórë	Endór**ello**
Númenórë	Númenór**ello**

	tul-	quet-	ná-
ni	tul**in**	quet**in**	**nanyë**
elyë	tul**ilyë**	quet**ilyë**	**nalyë**
se	tul**ë**	quet**ë**	**ná**

Ma …?	Ná.	Ui.
Ma quetilyë Quenya?	Ná, quetin Quenya.	Ui, lá quetin Quenya.
Ma tulilyë Tirionello?	Ná, tulin Tirionello.	Ui, tulin Valimarello.

Elda				Atan
Noldo	Vanya	Teler	Sinda	

1.5 Nóti

Á lasta! 1.8

	nótë
1	**minë**
2	**atta**
3	**neldë**
4	**canta**
5	**lempë**
6	**enquë**
7	**otso**
8	**tolto**
9	**nertë**
10	**quëan**



Figure 1.4: Mallo tulilyë?



Figure 1.5: Nóti

1.6 Lammar

Á lasta! 1.9

lamma	quettar
a	Aman, Atan
á	mára, málo
e	Elda, Elendil
é	nér
i	Tirion, minë
í	nís, síla
o	Noldo, otso
ó	lómë, Endórë
u	tulin, undómë
ú	Rúmil, Númenórë
ai	aiya
au	aurë, amaurë
oi	Oiolossë
ui	ui, Uinen
eu	leuca
c	canta, cenda
qu	Quenya, quëan
y	Vanya, aiya

1.7 Tengwar

a	e	i	o	u
𝼑	**𝼒**	**𝼓**	**𝼔**	**𝼕**

á	é	í	ó	ú
𝼑́	𝼒́	𝼓́	𝼔́	𝼕́

tengwa			quetta	
númen	𝼚	n	𝼚𝼑́	ná
malta	𝼛	m	𝼛𝼑́	ma
lambë	𝼖	l	𝼖𝼔́𝼛	lómë

tengwa			quetta	
rómen		r		mára
órë		r		ar

n	na	ná	namárië

1.8 Carië

1. Á lasta ar á tecë!

Á lasta! 1.10

amaurë · endaurë · sinyë · lómë

	Mára …!
1	Mára _____!
2	Mára _____!
3	Mára _____!
4	Mára _____!

2. Á quanta!

Á na márië · Alla · hantanyel · Manen · Mára

Nerdanel: _____, Elenwë!
Elenwë: Alla, Nerdanel! _____ nalyë?
Nerdanel: _____, hantanyel. Ar elyë?
Elenwë: Mára, _____.
Nerdanel: _____, Elenwë!

3. Á cenda ar á tecë i nóti: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5!

_____	**Rúmil:** Aiya, Elendil! Manen nalyë?
_____	**Elendil:** Namárië!
_____	**Elendil:** Aiya, Rúmil!
_____	**Rúmil:** Mára. Namárië, Elendil!

_____	**Elendil:** Mára, hantanyel. Ar elyë?

4. Á cenda (1.7) ar á tecë i hanquentar!

1. Mallo tulë Elenwë?
2. Mallo tulë Voronwë?
3. Mallo tulë Elendil?
4. Man quetë Sindarin?
5. Ma quetë Elendil Sindarin?
6. Man ná i istyar?

5. Á tecë!

Elda · Atan · Noldo · Vanya · Teler · Sinda

Essenya ná _____.
Nanyë _____.
Tulin _____.
Quetin _____.

6. Á notë ar á tecë!

3	neldë
5	_____
1	_____
8	_____
10	_____
_____	canta
_____	otso
_____	atta
_____	nertë
_____	enquë

7. Á lasta (1.9) ar á enquetë!

Aman · mára · Elda · nér · Tirion · nís · Noldo · lómë · tulin · Rúmil · aiya · aurë · Oiolossë · ui · leuca · canta · Quenya · Vanya

8. Á quetë as málo!

Elyë	Málolya
Elenwë · Valimarello · Vanya · Quenya	Elendil · Númenórello · Atan · Quenya
Nerdanel · Tirionello · Noldo · Quenya	Voronwë · Endórello · Noldo · Quenya ar Sindarin

Aiya! Essenya ná _____. Mana esselya?
Mallo tulilyë?
Ma quetilyë _____?
Namárië!

9. Á cenda i tengwar!

	_____
	_____
	_____
	_____
	_____
	_____

10. Á tecë tengwar!

ar	_____
mára	_____
lómë	_____
namárië	_____
Á na márië	_____

Hanquentar

1. 1 sinyë · 2 amaurë · 3 lómë · 4 endaurë
2. Alla · Manen · Mára · hantanyel · Á na márië
3. 2 · 5 · 1 · 4 · 3
4. 1 Valimarello. · 2 Endórello. · 3 Númenórello. · 4 Voronwë. · 5 Ui. · 6 Rúmil.
6. lempë · minë · tolto · quëan · 4 · 7 · 2 · 9 · 6

9. minë · lúmë · manen · Rúmil · elen · Númenórë
10. 𝼈𝼉 · 𝼌𝼍𝼎 · 𝼏𝼐𝼑 · 𝼒𝼌𝼍𝼎𝼏𝼊 · 𝼍 𝼒𝼌 𝼌𝼍𝼎𝼏𝼊

1.9 Quettar

Quetta	Eldamo
á	Q.
á na márië	Q.
aiya	Q.
alla	Q.
amaurë	Q.*
apárilë	NQ.
ar	Q.
as	Q.#
Atan	Q.
atta	Q.
aurë	Q.
canta	Q.
carië	Q.
cenda-	Q.
Elda	Q.
elen	Q.
elen síla lúmenn' omentielvo	Q.
elyë	Q.
endaurë	NQ.
enquë	Q.
enquet-	Q.
essë	Q.
hanquenta	Q.
hanta-	NQ.
i	Q.
istyar	MQ.
lá	Q.
lambë	Q.
lamma	MQ.
lasta-	Q.
lempë	Q.
leuca	Q.
lómë	Q.

Quetta	Eldamo
lúmë	Q.
ma	Q.
málo	Q.
mallo	MQ.
malta	Q.
man	Q.
mana	Q.
manen	Q.
mára	Q.
márië	Q.
mi	Q.
minë	MQ.
ná-	Q.
ná	Q.
namárië	Q.
neldë	Q.
nér	Q.
nertë	Q.
ni	Q.
nís	Q.
Noldo	Q.
not-	Q.
nótë	MQ.
númen	Q.
omentië	Q.
órë	Q.
otso	Q.
parandë	NQ.
quanta-	Q.
quëan	Q.
Quenya	Q.
quet-	Q.
quetta	Q.
rómen	Q.
se	Q.
sil-	Q.
Sinda	Q.
Sindarin	Q.
sinyë [þ]	MQ.
tec-	MQ.
Teler	Q.

Quetta	Eldamo
tengwa	Q.
tolto	Q.
tul-	Q.
ui	Q.
undómë	Q.
Vanya	Q.
-llo	Q.
-lya	Q.
-lyë	Q.
-n	Q.
-nya	Q.

1.10 Essi

Essë	Eldamo
Alqualondë	Q.
Aman	Q.
Avallónë	Q.
Elendil	Q.
Elenwë	Q.
Endórë	Q.
Nerdanel	Q.
Númenórë	Q.
Oiolossë	Q.
Rúmil	Q.
Tirion	Q.
Uinen	Q.
Valimar	Q.
Voronwë	Q.

2 Parandë

3 Parandë

4 Parandë

Content

5 Parandë

Content

6 Parandë

Content

Neologisms

The book does not coin any words of its own. Chapters are called *parandë* "(school) lesson", a Neo-Quenya word recorded in Eldamo (from *par-* "to learn"), which replaced our earlier coinage *carincë*. Every word marked **NQ.** in the word lists is a neologism from Eldamo, which names its author and explains how it was formed.

If a future chapter needs a word that neither Tolkien nor Eldamo provides, it will be listed here with its formation and the Eldamo entries it is built from.

Cariquettar